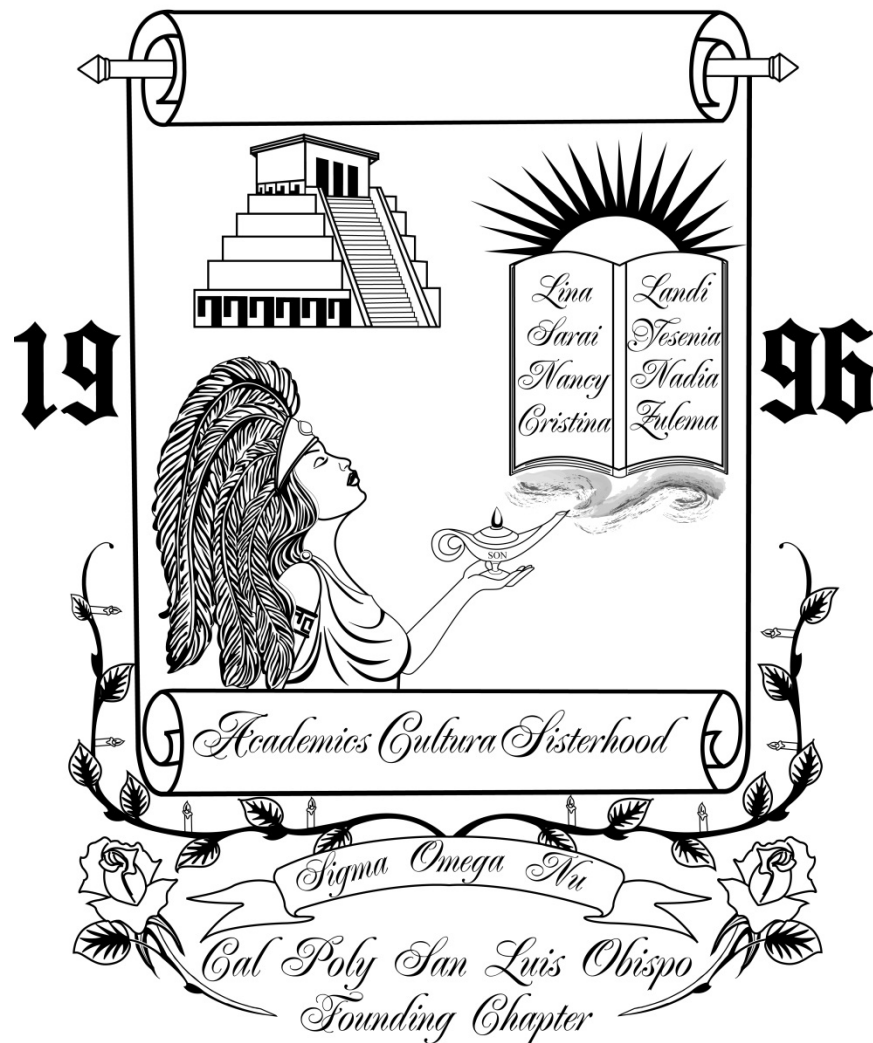


SIGMA OMEGA NU

LATINA INTEREST SORORITY INC.

ΣΩΝ



UNDERGRADUATE EXPANSION PROCESS

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SIGMA OMEGA NU LATINA INTEREST SORORITY, INC.

UNDERGRADUATE EXPANSION PROCESS

PART I. PURPOSE

The Director of Expansion oversees all expansion efforts that could potentially result in the establishment of new Undergraduate Chapters of Sigma Omega Nu. The Director of Expansion is responsible for presentations to interest groups, Greek Councils, and potential Chapter Advisors. She monitors the progress of all interest groups and Official Interest Groups. Once a new Chapter is established, she is responsible for mentoring the new chapter in their first few months of establishment, and transitioning the new Chapter to oversight by the NVP of Undergraduate Affairs and the applicable Regional Director.

PART II. EXPANSION OVERVIEW

The expansion process consists of four phases: Interest Group; Official Interest Group; Colony; Chapter. Each phase is described below.

Section A. Phase One: Interest Group

The Interest Group process is led by the group of interested women themselves. Typically, though not always, the group of women has already explored the other sororities established at their campus and determined they were not the right fit for them. They may have learned about Sigma Omega Nu through other Greek organizations, through an internet search, or by having met Sisters of Sigma Omega Nu. At this point, they have no obligation to this Sorority. They may also be communicating with the national director of expansion from one or more other sororities, to figure out which organization fits them best. If the interested women determine they want to move forward with establishing a Chapter of Sigma Omega Nu, they must meet certain minimum requirements before they can move on to the next Phase.

Section B. Phase Two: Official Interest Group

This phase is overseen by the Director of Expansion, and may only be started once all of the minimum interest group requirements have been met by all interested members. Once recognized as an Official Interest Group, the members and the group itself are officially and legally associated with the Sorority. During this phase, the Official Interest Group will work on establishing many of the business requirements of a Chapter, such as establishing a bank account, selecting an advisor, and beginning the process of Council recognition.

Section C. Phase Three: Colony

Once the Official Interest Group completes the requirements of that phase, and the National Board agrees to continue with the expansion process, the Official Interest Group will become a Colony. The Colony phase is equivalent to Pledgeship at an established Chapter, and is led by Colony Directors that are elected for each specific Colony. Through this process, the women will learn about the inner workings of the Sorority, and what it means to be a Sister and Founding Sister of Sigma Omega Nu.

Section D. Phase Four: Chapter

Once the Colony has met all requirements of that phase, they may become a Chapter of Sigma Omega Nu. The individual women will be recognized as Founding Sisters of the Chapter and as Sisters of Sigma Omega Nu as a whole. In the months immediately following the establishment of the Chapter, the Director of Expansion works with the new Chapter to ensure they have everything to become self-sufficient. During this time, oversight is also transitioned from the Director of Expansion to the NVP of Undergraduate Affairs and the applicable Regional Director.

PART III. INTEREST GROUP

The following process should be followed during the Interest Group phase.

Section A. Contact from Interested Women

Interested women will contact Sigma Omega Nu through expansion@sigmaomeganu.org or through national.sunnies@gmail.com. The Director of Expansion should respond to the email as soon after receiving it as possible. Attach the Sigma Omega Nu Informational Brochure (PDF) to the email.

Section B. Inquire with the Greek Council

Contact the appropriate Greek Council at the University. The Council President and/or Council Advisor should have contact information easily accessible on the University's Greek Life website. If not, request this information from the interested women. The purpose of this initial contact is to find out if the University and/or the Greek Council are open for expansion considerations, and if so, what the Council's expansion policies are. Include the Sigma Omega Nu Council Info Flyer (PDF) as an attachment to the email.

The University's Greek Life website will also usually indicate which Latina and/or multicultural sororities are already established on campus. This information, along with University demographics, will help the Director of Expansion gauge the likelihood of success of the potential future chapter. The Director of Expansion will need to be prepared with this information during the National Board's discussion on whether or not to pursue establishing a chapter.

If the University and/or the Council are not open for the addition of new organizations, ask if there is a known date for when they will be open again. There is a good chance they will not have a specific date in mind, and may be willing to accept a letter of interest to keep on file for when they are open for expansion. This information will need to be communicated back to the interested women. They will need to decide if they want to continue to pursue establishing a new chapter of Sigma Omega Nu on an unknown timeline, or if they want to re-consider joining an existing sorority. If the University and/or the Council are not open for expansion, the expansion process will effectively end at this step until such time as the University and Council are willing to consider new organizations, and the Interest Group is still willing to pursue the establishment of a new chapter.

Section C. Informational Presentation

If the Council is open for expansion considerations, coordinate with the primary contact person from the Interest Group to schedule an Informational Presentation to take place within two months of the initial contact. This presentation is very similar to those given during recruitment and rush events at an established Chapter, with the addition of more information about the overall expansion process.

The presentation should be held on-campus, or at a location easily accessible from campus, preferably a "smart room" with presentation capabilities. Most smart rooms will have either a VGA (blue) or HDMI port to connect to, but it is recommended that you bring multiple adapter cables to ensure an easy connection (i.e., Mac to PC, display port to HDMI, VGA [blue] to HDMI, DVI [white] to HDMI, etc.). If

presentation capabilities are not available, bring 10 hardcopies of the presentation to pass out. Coordinate the reservation of a room with the primary contact person, and ensure the room is large enough for 15 – 20 attendees. If an in-person presentation is not possible, a virtual presentation is also acceptable - coordinate with the National Board President to use of the national video conferencing account.

Section D. Official Interest Group Application

Once the Interest Group has met all minimum requirements, and the appropriate Greek Council is open to expansion, the Director of Expansion will provide the Interest Group with the Official Interest Group Application (PDF). The Director of Expansion will provide a deadline to submit the application that is no less than three weeks prior to the next National Board meeting. Once the application is received, review for completeness and request any missing information. If missing information is not received within one week, the vote for expansion must be rescheduled for the following National Board meeting. Additional members may be added to the roster up to one week prior to the scheduled vote for expansion.

Once the completed application is received, prepare the following to present at the next National Board meeting:

1. A brief presentation of the Interested Women, including their picture and some general background information such as hometown, year in school, and major.
2. A Strategic Plan for the entire expansion process, accounting for any known constraints or opportunities. See Section F below.

Section E. Vote for Expansion

At the identified National Board meeting, the Director of Expansion will motion to continue or not continue with the expansion process with the identified group. A simple affirmative majority is required to continue the expansion process.

No later than two weeks following the National Board meeting, notify the Interest Group of the result of the vote. If the result is not to continue with the group, provide a brief description as to why. If the result is to continue, congratulate the group and request a date and time when all members are available to meet for their first meeting.

Section F. Strategic Plan

The Strategic Plan is intended to provide a roadmap for the establishment of the potential new chapter. It should account for all known issues that could impact the progress of the group. This may include things like the Council's approval process, holiday/summer breaks, travel logistics, relationships with other Greek organizations on campus, and the number of members close to graduation. A projected timeline should be included, as well as the anticipated Region that the potential new chapter would be a part of. This timeline should include anticipated duration for the Official Interest Group process, the Colony process, and Post-Colony workshops, as well as anticipated dates for major milestone events, including when Colony Directors should be elected. At minimum identify month and year for major milestone events – exact dates are not required.

Section G. Participation

The following are considered expected and acceptable levels of participation during the Colony process. See the National Bylaws and Standardized Colony Pledgeship for additional information about roles and responsibilities.

1. Director of Expansion

The Director of Expansion is responsible for communication with the Interest Group, and relaying that information to the National Board. The Director of Expansion will notify the

National Board, Chapters, and Alumnae of any activities or events where their assistance is needed or participation is requested.

2. Regional Director

The Director of Expansion may request assistance from the applicable Regional Director throughout the Interest Group phase. This may include, but not limited to, assistance with on-campus recruitment and with the Informational Presentation.

3. Other National Officers

Other National Officers are not required to participate in activities or events during the Interest Group process. National Officers are required to be present during the National Board meeting when the discussion and vote is held on whether or not to recognize an Interest Group as an Official Interest Group.

4. Chapters

Chapters are not required to participate in activities or events during the Interest Group process.

5. Alumnae

Alumnae are not required to participate in activities or events during the Interest Group process. However, the Director of Expansion or Regional Director may request assistance from Alumnae living near the applicable University throughout the Interest Group phase. This may include, but not limited to, assistance with on-campus recruitment and with the Informational Presentation.

6. All Members of Sigma Omega Nu

Under no circumstances can any member of Sigma Omega Nu provide direction or instruction to the Interest Group without prior coordination with the Director of Expansion. Concerns, comments, or questions, including those regarding performance and commitment of the interested members, must be addressed to the Director of Expansion directly, and not to the interested members.

PART IV. OFFICIAL INTEREST GROUP

Section A. Constitution And Bylaws

The Official Interest Group process is governed by the Official Interest Group Constitution and Bylaws. The Constitution and Bylaws were written with the expectation that they would need to be submitted to the University and/or Council, and it is acceptable to submit in its full form, without redaction.

Section B. Requirements

The Official Interest Group Constitution and Bylaws outline the requirements of individual members as well as the group as a whole. These requirements are listed in Article V. Requirements. A few of the more important requirements are detailed here.

The Official Interest Group is required to select an advisor, in accordance with Article XI. Advisor of the Official Interest Group Constitution and Bylaws. The Director of Expansion and the members of the Official Interest Group are required to provide the chosen advisor with more information about Sigma Omega Nu. If requested by the chosen advisor, the Director of Expansion will arrange for an informational presentation.

The Official Interest Group must select a local nonprofit organization supporting a cause that is important to the group, and identify this as their Philanthropy. The chosen organization is approved unanimously. Each member must complete a minimum of 10 hours of community service during the Official Interest

Group process. The group should be encouraged to complete all or most of their required community service hours with the chosen philanthropy.

Section C. First Meeting

Once the group is notified of the decision to move forward with the Official Interest Group process, the Director of Expansion will request a date and time when all members are available to meet for their first meeting. This meeting should be held within four weeks after being notified of the decision to move forward. It is recommended this meeting be held in person, but virtual is also acceptable.

Prior to the first meeting, the Director of Expansion will send electronic copies of all documents required in the Official Interest Group binder, as well as a meeting agenda. Review all documents before sending to ensure they are update to date and current. Notify the members that they are required to provide their own black binder with clear front cover and a minimum of 5 divider tabs. The meeting shall be run in accordance with Sigma Omega Nu General Meeting procedures. During the meeting, make sure to include time to review the binder contents. See Appendix A for a sample agenda.

The Director of Expansion will take prepare meeting minutes following this first meeting, but then the Secretary will take over after that. Make sure the Secretary understands the difference between the meeting agenda and meeting minutes.

Section D. Monitor Progress

The Director of Expansion must monitor the progress of the Official Interest Group by reviewing meeting minutes, providing feedback, and asking for clarification when necessary. If the group is showing signs of lack of progress, it may be necessary for the Director of Expansion to become more actively involved in the meetings.

Announce major events to Sisters in the Region where the potential new chapter would be established. During National Board meetings, provide updates to the officers on the Official Interest Groups' progress, including completion of major milestone activities.

Section E. Official Interest Group Interviews

As the Official Interest Group gets close to completing all requirements, the Director of Expansion will schedule an interview of the Official Interest Group by the National Board. This should coincide with a National Board meeting, either before or after the meeting. It is preferred that the interviews be held in person, but virtual is also acceptable. Additional coordination regarding format may be required if held virtually.

Prior to the meeting, the Director of Expansion should update the timeline identified in the Strategic Plan. The Director of Expansion must also prepare and submit the New Pledge Class Induction form along with all unofficial transcripts to the NVP of Undergraduate Affairs prior to the Official Interest Group Interviews.

Following the interviews, the Director of Expansion will review the Strategic Plan with National Board, and answer any questions the Board may have regarding the group and their ability to successfully complete the expansion process. The Director of Expansion will then motion to continue the expansion process or not.

Section F. Participation

The following are considered expected and acceptable levels of participation during the Official Interest Group process. See the National Bylaws for additional information about roles and responsibilities.

1. Director of Expansion

The Director of Expansion is responsible for overseeing the Official Interest Group process, including relaying progress of the group to the National Board. The Director of Expansion will

notify the National Board and Chapters of any activities or events where their assistance is needed or participation is requested.

2. Other National Officers

Other National Officers are not required to participate in activities or events during the Official Interest Group process. National Officers are required to be present during the National Board meeting when the discussion and vote is held on whether or not to move forward with the Colony process.

3. Chapters within the Region

Chapters within the applicable Region are not required to participate in activities or events during the Official Interest Group process. Chapters are encouraged to attend events hosted by the Official Interest Group, such as fundraisers and community service events.

4. Chapters outside the Region

Chapters outside the applicable Region are not required to participate in activities or events during the Official Interest Group process. Chapters are encouraged to attend events hosted by the Official Interest Group, such as fundraisers and community service events.

5. Alumnae

Alumnae are not required to participate in activities or events during the Official Interest Group process. However, the Director of Expansion or Regional Director may request assistance from Alumnae living near the applicable University throughout the Official Interest Group phase. This may include, but not limited to, assistance with on-campus recruitment and with the Informational Presentation to the applicable Greek Council. Alumnae are encouraged to attend events hosted by the Official Interest Group, such as fundraisers and community service events.

6. All Members of Sigma Omega Nu

Under no circumstances can any member of Sigma Omega Nu provide direction or instruction to the Official Interest Group without prior coordination with the Director of Expansion. Concerns, comments, or questions, including those regarding performance and commitment of the members, must be addressed to the Director of Expansion directly, and not to the members of the Official Interest Group.

PART V. COLONY

Section A. Standardized Colony Pledgeship

The complete Colony pledgeship process is outlined in detail in the Sigma Omega Nu Standardized Colony Pledgeship. This phase of the expansion process is overseen by Colony Directors who are elected specifically for each individual Colony.

The Colony Directors are to be elected in accordance with the timeline identified in the Strategic Plan prepared by the Director of Expansion.

If for any reason the University asks for a copy of our new member education process, this can be provided but all descriptions of ceremonies, traditions, and meanings must be redacted. Discuss with the National Board President if unsure about what needs to be redacted.

Section B. Progress Reviews

The Director of Expansion, in coordination with the Regional Director, will hold monthly progress check-ins with the members of the Colony, independent of meetings held with the Colony Directors. The

purpose of these meetings is three-fold. First, it is a way for the potential future chapter to start developing a relationship with their future Regional Director. Second, it is a way for the Director of Expansion to receive feedback and lessons learned on the Colony process with the goal of improving the pledgeship process for future colonies. Third, the feedback received by the Director of Expansion and Regional Director can be shared anonymously with the Colony Directors to assist in improving the pledgeship process in real time.

Section C. Participation

The following are considered expected and acceptable levels of participation during the Colony process. See the National Bylaws and Standardized Colony Pledgeship for additional information about roles and responsibilities.

1. Director of Expansion

The Director of Expansion has no direct responsibility for the Colony process. The Director of Expansion will coordinate with the Regional Director to have monthly check-ins with the Colony. The Director of Expansion must attend Pinning, Crossover, and the Big Sister Little Sister Dinner. If the Director of Expansion is asked to serve on the Colony Pledge Committee, she must also attend the Candlelight Exchange. The Director of Expansion will remain the primary contact for the applicable Greek Council through the Colony process.

2. Colony Directors

Colony Directors are responsible for planning and executing all requirements of the Colony Pledgeship process. They must attend all Colony ceremonies and events. They are encouraged to participate in or attend activities organized by the Colony.

3. Regional Director

The Regional Director will be a member of the Colony Pledge Committee. The Regional Director will coordinate with the Director of Expansion to have monthly check-ins with the Colony. The Regional Director must attend Pinning, Crossover, the Big Sister Little Sister Dinner, and the Candlelight Exchange. They are encouraged to participate in or attend activities organized by the Colony.

4. Other National Officers

The Executive Cabinet is required to participate in all Colony ceremonies and events. All National Board Members are required to attend Pinning, Crossover, and the Big Sister Little Sister Dinner. All National Board Members are welcome to attend the Candlelight Exchange.

5. Chapters within the Region

Chapter Representatives are required to attend the Pinning and Crossover ceremonies, as well as the Big Sister Little Sister Dinner. Chapters are encouraged to attend events hosted by the Colony, such as fundraisers and community service events.

6. Chapters outside the Region

Chapter Representatives are required to attend the Pinning and Crossover ceremonies. Chapters are encouraged to attend events hosted by the Colony, such as fundraisers and community service events.

1. Alumnae

Alumnae are not required to participate in activities or events during the Colony process. Those wishing to participate in Colony events must be in Good Standing with their Chapter and with the

National Board, and must coordinate their participation with the Colony Directors in advance of the event.

2. All Members of Sigma Omega Nu

Under no circumstances can any member of Sigma Omega Nu provide direction or instruction to the Colony without prior coordination with the Colony Directors. Concerns, comments, or questions, including those regarding performance and commitment of the interested members, must be addressed to the Pledge Committee directly, and not to the Little Sisters.

PART VI. CHAPTER

Section A. Post-Colony Workshops

The Director of Expansion must coordinate the Post-Colony Workshops. Once a crossover date is known, she should begin making arrangements with the NVP of Undergraduate Affairs to ensure all required information is collected and prepared in advance of the workshops. Work with the Colony Directors to discretely schedule the workshops within the month after the anticipated date of Crossover.

There are a total of five workshops. These workshops contain a lot of information, and it is best if they are spread out over 2 or 3 days. Include time in the workshops to practice filling out forms or other documents.

Section B. Council Recognition

Within 48 hours of the Chapter being established, the Director of Expansion must formally notify the applicable Greek Council. The chosen Chapter Advisor must also be notified. The contact information for the NVP of Undergraduate Affairs and the Regional Director should also be provided to both the Council and the Advisor.

If the Council or University requires that they are named as an additional ensured entity on our General Liability insurance policy, work with the National President to get this documentation. Once received from the insurance provider, send to the Council immediately.

Section C. Transfer of Oversight Responsibility

Once the Post-Colony Workshops are complete and the Council has received the requisite information about the new Chapter, the Director of Expansion's efforts are complete. The NVP of Undergraduate Affairs and Regional Director will then provide the required guidance and oversight to the new Chapter, the same as all other Chapters of Sigma Omega Nu.

Section D. Participation

The following are considered expected and acceptable levels of participation during the first year of Chapter establishment.

1. Director of Expansion

The Director of Expansion must schedule and lead the Post-Colony Workshops.

2. National Vice President of Undergraduate Affairs

The NVP of Undergraduate Affairs must assist the Director of Expansion with the Post-Colony Workshops. The NVP of Undergraduate Affairs will hold monthly check-ins with the new Chapter for the first 12 months following Crossover.

3. Colony Directors

The Colony Directors' mandatory involvement ends with Crossover. They are encouraged to participate in the Post-Colony Workshops if invited by the Director of Expansion.

4. Regional Director

The Regional Directors are encouraged to participate in the Post-Colony Workshops if invited by the Director of Expansion. Once the Chapter is established, the Regional Director will incorporate the new Chapter into their communications and requirements within one week of crossover. The Regional Director will participate in the monthly check-ins held by the NVP of Undergraduate Affairs for the first 12 months following Crossover, and provide additional guidance following each meeting, as required.

5. Other National Officers

Once the Chapter is established, the National Officers will incorporate the new Chapter into their communications and requirements within one week of crossover. The Director of Expansion may request assistance from National Officers in preparation for the Post-Colony Workshops, or may request their attendance at one or more of the workshops to assist with presenting and explaining the information and requirements.

PART VII. SPECIAL SITUATIONS

Section A. ΣΩΝ Closed for Expansion

On occasion, the National Board may determine it is in the best interest of the Sorority to temporarily stop expansion efforts. This would not affect recruitment at existing Chapters, only the establishment of new chapters. This could be for any number of reasons, and should be for a pre-determined amount of time. A temporary halt on expansion efforts does not prevent the Director of Expansion from providing general information to those that express interest in establishing a new Chapter, including providing brochures and/or organizing an in-person informational. Depending on the make-up of the interest group, they may have enough 1st or 2nd year members that could wait out the closure and still be around long enough to establish a chapter. See Appendix B for a sample email sent during an expansion closure.

Section B. Closing a Chapter

Closing a Chapter may be the result of a variety of reasons. Most likely it will be one of three reasons listed below, all of which have been experienced by Sigma Omega Nu at one time or another.

1. All members have graduated

In the event the Chapter is unable to initiate new members prior to all Active Sisters graduating, the Chapter will go into a dormant status. Find out from the Council what steps would need to be taken in order for the Chapter to be re-established. See Section C. Re-Establishing a Chapter.

2. The Chapter loses recognition from the University or Council.

This will occur as the result of the Chapter not meeting the University or Council's minimum requirements for membership, or as the result of a disciplinary action by the University or Council. In advance of losing recognition, the Chapter will most likely be placed in some sort of probationary or associate member status, and given a deadline to make the required improvements. During this probationary period, support the NVP of Undergraduate Affairs and the Regional Director in any way possible to ensure all identified requirements are met. If the Chapter is ultimately required to close, inquire with the Council if they would need to go through the formal Council expansion process again to re-gain recognition. In the event the University and/or the Council bans the Sorority from re-establishing, the Chapter must follow the consequences set forth by each or both. In the event of being banned from campus, the Chapter

must close until such time as the ban is lifted and/or the University or Council's expansion policies have changed.

3. The University closes.

This is a rare situation but it has happened. A University may close if it loses its accreditation as a higher education institution. In this case, the Chapter can either close entirely, or attempt to transfer to another nearby University. See Section D Transferring a Chapter.

Section C. Re-Establishing a Chapter

In the unfortunate situation when a Chapter is forced to close, but later has the opportunity to re-establish, the newly interested women are required to go through the Official Interest Group process and the Colony Pledgeship process. This assumes that there are no Sisters remaining at the campus that could serve as Pledge Mothers. Once the group reaches the Colony stage, they will be recognized in the following format: Gamma Colony Delta Pledge Class. There may be some portions of the Colony Pledgeship Process where portions of the Chapter Pledgeship Process could be substituted in or added in addition to the Colony requirements. For example, the Colony should interview the Chapter Founding Sisters in addition to the National Board officers. Once the Chapter is re-established, the new Sisters shall not be given any special title on par with the Founding Sister status. However, the re-established Chapter may work with the Founding Sisters to amend the Chapter History to acknowledge their contribution.

Section D. Transferring a Chapter

In the event of a University closing, the Director of Expansion should look into the possibility of transferring the Chapter to whichever University that the majority of Sisters are transferring to. This University is most likely a local University that is aware of the closing University's situation, and likely accepting transfer students through an abridged transfer process. The Director of Expansion should contact the Greek Council as soon as the Sisters know where they are transferring to discuss options. As long as there are Sisters willing to remain Active at the transferred Chapter, and the Chapter would meet all minimum requirements of the new University, the members would not need to go through the Colony Pledgeship process. The Director of Expansion should work with the transferred Chapter as they work through the requirements of the University and the Council, since they already know how to comply with Sigma Omega Nu's requirements.

PART VIII. WORKING WITH GREEK COUNCILS

Section A. Types of Greek Councils

There are up to four councils that you will most likely interact with on any given campus. The first three councils listed here are almost always present, though in some cases only the first two. Each council is typically associated with an umbrella organization, but not always.

1. Panhellenic Council. The Panhellenic Council is the council for 26 traditional social sororities and fraternities for women. Many of these organizations were founded in the late 1800s and early 1900s, which is why some use the term "women's fraternity" in their name. The National Panhellenic Conference (NPC) is the umbrella organization for these organizations. Occasionally, sororities that are not members of NPC may be included in the Panhellenic Council as associate members. This may happen when there are too few organizations to create and sustain multiple councils, or if the associate member organization wants access to the formal Panhellenic Council bid process. Religious-based sororities are most often associate members of the Panhellenic Council, but not always.
2. Inter-Fraternity Council. Often called IFC for short, this council represents the 75 traditional social fraternities for men. In recent years culturally based fraternities have become members of

the umbrella organization, North American Interfraternity Council (NIC) specifically for access to the larger pool of potential candidates. Religious-based fraternities are most often associate members of the Panhellenic Council, but not always.

3. Multicultural Council. The council created for culturally-based organizations typically has one of three names: Multicultural Greek Council (MGC), Cultural Greek Council (CGC), or United Sorority and Fraternity Council (USFC). There is usually no umbrella organization associated with this council, however there is an actual National Multicultural Greek Council that serves as an umbrella organization for 11 multicultural fraternities and sororities. The multicultural council will often include all fraternities and sororities that have some sort of cultural, religious, or gender focus, though occasionally these organizations may seek membership to the NPC or IFC councils for access to a larger pool of prospective new members.
4. National Pan-Hellenic Council. The NPHC, or Divine Nine, are the 9 original Black fraternities and sororities founded in the early 1900s. When there are not enough organizations on campus to sustain a dedicated NPHC, they will often be a member organization of the Multicultural Council.

There are other councils that are less common, but are included here for your general awareness.

1. National Association of Latino Fraternal Organizations (NALFO). Umbrella organization for Latinx fraternities and sororities. There are very few established NALFO councils.
2. National APIDA Panhellenic Association (NAPA). Umbrella organization for Asian fraternities and sororities.
3. National Multicultural Greek Council (NMGC). Umbrella organization for recognized multicultural fraternities and sororities.

Since Sigma Omega Nu is a member of NALFO, membership into a NALFO council is guaranteed. However, since so few NALFO councils exist, any future chapter would most likely be a member of the multicultural council. If uncertain which council a new chapter would belong to, reach out to the university's Greek advisor.

Section B. Petition for Membership

If a Council indicates that it is open for expansion considerations, make sure to get a copy of the Council's Constitution, Bylaws, and expansion policy as soon as possible. Review the policy thoroughly to understand what is required of the interest group as well as of National Board. The timing of the petition for membership may have a significant impact on our expansion timeline, and may even determine if we pursue expansion at that University at all. All Councils require some sort of petition for membership, but the specific requirements vary greatly. Below is a list of Council expansion policies previously encountered.

1. Petition for membership required before recognition as an Official Interest Group.
2. Petition for membership required after recognition as an Official Interest Group but before establishing a chapter.
3. Petition for membership allowed only after the Chapter has been established.

Additionally, recognition by the University may or may not be required in any of these situations. Sigma Omega Nu's expansion policy requires the OIG to become a recognized club by the University under a club name. Based on the University's policies, this club status will likely remain in place until recognized by a Greek Council. However, whether or not Sigma Omega Nu establishes a Chapter while recognized as a club is dependent on University policies. Some Universities may revoke club status once a Chapter is established. This would require the Chapter to become an "underground" organization, subject to limited, if any, access to University and/or Council resources. It has become generally accepted by the National Board that we will not allow Chapters to become "underground" organizations. This puts the

Chapter in a risky situation that could potentially lead to the failure of the Chapter. This is what happened with the Gamma Chapter in 2004. Though the Chapter was established in 2002, the Council banned our membership as a result of “underground” activities. It was not until 2012, after University and Council policies changed, that the Gamma Chapter was able to be re-established.

The petition itself is typically composed of two parts: an application and a presentation.

1. Application.

This typically includes documentation that the group meets the minimum requirements for membership. This may be required to be submitted before the presentation or at the presentation. If the application is required before the presentation, it is likely being used as a screening tool before offering the opportunity to present.

2. Presentation

The requirements of the presentation will vary by Council. Some may require specific policies to be discussed, such as hazing, drug & alcohol, or sexual assault policies. Some may require discussion on how Sigma Omega Nu is different or stands out from existing Latina sororities. And some may require further discussion on how the interest group meets the minimum requirements of membership. Make sure to spend time preparing for this presentation. Update the template presentation slides to include all requirements. Also prepare for any questions that may be asked. You should have already researched statistics about the University, the Council, or other Latina sororities to include in the Strategic Plan, but if the presentation is occurring more than a year after the Strategic Plan was created, you should verify that those statistics are still accurate. If you suspect that the majority of the Council has already made up their minds on how to vote, consider printing out the Informational Card to pass out at the presentation. That way they will have something to reference as they discuss prior to their vote. Below are some typical questions that might be asked, along with sample responses. Again, make sure you tailor your responses to the specific interest group/colony and Council/University, making sure the information about Sigma Omega Nu is also current and accurate.

- a. What makes Sigma Omega Nu different from the other Latina sororities already in the Council?

- SON is a medium sized regional sorority. There are currently three Latina sororities already established in the Council: two large national sororities and one medium regional sorority. There are also 4 established Latino fraternities and 4 established multicultural sororities. The addition of Sigma Omega Nu would help even out the options available to students.
- SON has no national philanthropy. Instead, each chapter chooses an organization that is of importance to their members and their community. The Official Interest Group has chosen [organization] as their desired philanthropy. To date, the Official Interest Group has completed 320 hours of community service, with 100 of those hours done directly with their chosen philanthropy.
- SON is younger than any of the currently established Latina sororities. We are still of the size where each of our Chapters has the opportunity to make a lasting impact on the future of the Sorority.

- With 16 undergraduate Chapters, SON is smaller than any of the existing Latina sororities. This allows our National Board to focus on chapter and member development that may not be as easily accessible in a larger organization
- b. What can Sigma Omega Nu bring/contribute to the Council?
- Sigma Omega Nu brings a strong emphasis on academic excellence to the council. Our academic requirements are some of the most stringent of any organization, requiring a minimum 2.5 cumulative GPA *AND* a minimum 2.3 term GPA.
 - Many of the members of the Official Interest Group hold leadership positions in 10 other student clubs and academic organizations on campus. Their leadership in these other organizations will serve as outreach not only for Sigma Omega Nu, but for the entire council, and may reach additional students that would not have otherwise considered Greek Life.

PART II. EXPANSION RELATED EXPENSES

There is a standing budget for expansion related expenses in the amount of \$1,000 per calendar year. It is the responsibility of the Director of Expansion to use it as judiciously as possible. A tentative and final expense budget are required to be submitted for each expansion effort, in accordance with Sigma Omega Nu financial procedures. Expenses eligible for reimbursement include travel and printing costs associated with interest informationals, council presentations, Post-Colony Workshops, and other meetings required to be held in person. Expenses during colony pledgship phase are covered by the dues paid by the Little Sisters and do not count towards the Expansion budget.